

from throttling issues, which become evident during extended use or intensive tasks, and also through the CPU Throttling Test. The device heats up significantly while gaming or running benchmarks leading to performance drops and occasional stuttering.

As for software, Motorola's Hello UI is one of the best Android skins out there. It has minimal bloatware in the form of third-party apps and the skin is very close to the beloved Stock Android interface. Moto also promises three years of software updates and four years of security updates. The UI is extremely functional with an array of features and customisation opportunities. Features such as Smart Connect set it apart from the competition too.

AI

Motorola has heavily marketed the AI capabilities of the Razr 50 Ultra, positioning it as a device with advanced AI features. The Gemini AI on the cover screen is one such highlight. Motorola also offers users three months of Gemini Advanced features for free, including 2TB of Google Cloud storage. The AI camera features, such as Photo Enhancement and Super Zoom, aim to improve the photography experience. Additionally, Motorola promises access to Google Photos' Magic Eraser, Photo Unblur, and Magic Editor. There are also some in-house Moto AI features that allow you to generate wallpapers based on text prompts and images.

Sadly, the Razr 50 Ultra's own hardware AI performance was underwhelming in benchmarks. Tests assessing object recognition, face recognition, camera scene detection, and image deblurring showed mediocre results. Surprisingly, the less expensive Moto Edge 50 Ultra outperformed the Razr 50 Ultra in these AI tests. The Motorola Razr 50 Ultra scored 32/100 in our Digit AI-Q test.

Despite the abundant AI features, the on-device AI processing does not live up to expectations. The AI capabilities are heavily reliant on third-party software, with much of the heavy lifting done by Google's AI tools rather than Motorola's own innovations. The potential is there, but the execution falls short.

CAMERA

The camera setup on the Razr 50 Ultra includes a 50 MP primary lens and a 50 MP telephoto lens, but it lacks an ultra-wide lens. The omission of the UW lens may disappoint some users who prefer the flexibility of wide-angle shots. Personally, I find the telephoto lens more useful than an ultra-wide, but preferences vary among users. In terms of performance, the cameras deliver good results. Portrait shots are impressive, with good detail and natural bokeh effects. Daylight shots have fantastic levels of detail and great dynamic range. The phone's 2x telephoto shooter maintains decent colour consistency and the quality of the photos is top-notch. However, low-light performance is less stellar, with noticeable lens flare. But the photos are still sharp, and surprisingly, portrait mode is exceptionally good in low light.

Sadly, the camera app suffers from lag, particularly when switching between modes or accessing advanced features. Additionally, the phone heats up significantly during extended photo sessions. I hope these issues get ironed out with future OTA updates.

Video recording on the Razr 50 Ultra is competent but not outstanding. While the stabilisation works well in most conditions, there are occasional hiccups, particularly in low-light or high-motion scenarios. The audio quality during video recording is acceptable, but not exceptional, with some background noise and distortion in noisy environments.

Overall, the camera performance of the Razr 50 Ultra is pretty good. The photos are impressive in daylight and low light, but the lens flare issue in low light docks some points in this segment.

BATTERY LIFE

The Razr 50 Ultra is equipped with a 4,000 mAh battery, which offers about a day's worth of usage under typical conditions. This is adequate but not impressive, especially considering the power-hungry features and large displays of the device.

For heavy users, particularly those who engage in gaming or extensive multimedia consumption, the battery life may fall

short, necessitating a mid-day recharge. The phone lasted 898 minutes, which equates to a little over 14 hours, in our 4K video loop test, which is average.

The device supports wireless charging, which is a convenient feature for users who prefer a cable-free charging experience. However, the charging speed, both wired and wireless, is average.

Power management is another area where the Razr 50 Ultra could improve. The device tends to drain the battery quickly under heavy load, and the power-saving features are not as effective as those on competing devices.

VERDICT

The Motorola Razr 50 Ultra is an intriguing blend of cutting-edge hardware and innovative AI features, with a standout cover screen that sets it apart from other flip phones. The device offers a premium feel and a satisfying foldable design, but it is not without its flaws. The performance and throttling issues may not fully justify its premium price. Additionally, the battery life is strictly mediocre.

The cover screen is a highlight though, offering unprecedented functionality for a flip phone. Additionally, both displays are top-notch in terms of specs and the build quality is amongst the best in this space. However, with the imminent launch of the Galaxy Z Flip 6, potential buyers might want to wait and compare before making a decision.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 | OS: Android 14, Hello UI | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 512 GB UFS 4.0 | Cover Display: 4" LTPO AMOLED, 165 Hz, 1272 x 1080 pixels, HDR10+, Dolby Vision | Inner Display: 6.9" LTPO AMOLED, 165 Hz, 1080 x 2640 pixels, HDR10+, Dolby Vision | Cover Display Protection: Gorilla Glass Victus | Cameras (rear): 50 MP primary + 50 MP telephoto | Selfie Camera: 32 MP | Video (rear and front): Up to 4K at 60 fps | IP Rating: IPX8 | Thickness: 7.1 mm (unfolded), 15.3 mm (unfolded) | Weight: 189 g | Battery Capacity: 4,000 mAh | Charging: 45 W (wired), 15 W (wireless), 5 W (reverse wireless) | Colours: Spring Green, Midnight Blue, Peach Fuzz

CONTACT

Company: Motorola | Phone: N/A | Email: Web form | Website: <https://www.motorola.in/>